



Snapdragon powered 5G laptop

Lenovo is the first company to tease a 5G laptop powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8cx processor. <https://digit.in/mar19-32>



LG G8 comes with "Hand ID"

Forget Face ID, the LG G8 ThinQ has a palm-reading "Hand ID" that will authenticate you via the veins in your hand! <https://digit.in/mar19-33>

BUYING ADVICE

HOT, HOT, HOT!

Q I have been reading Digit since I was in 8th standard and now I am in FY B.Tech. I really love the magazine. Now comes the problem part. I purchased Acer Predator Helios 300 in September last year. The specs are as follows:

- CPU - Intel Core i5 8300H
- RAM - 8 GB
- GPU - Nvidia GeForce GTX 1050 Ti
- SSD & HDD - 128 GB & 1 TB

When I play games it used to get very hot. Sometimes it touches 90°C.

But yesterday I was playing Far Cry 5 on high settings, it touched 98 even when the fans were on max. I was worried and closed the game immediately.

What should I do? Should I try undervolting the CPU? How should I do that?

—Tushar Ranjan



The Predator series

A I hope you've checked all the cooling vents to ensure that none of them are blocked, especially when you are gaming. Since the laptop is relatively new, we can safely assume that the thermal paste/pad for the CPU hasn't caked up yet. This means that undervolting should be a good solution.

Download Intel Extreme Tuning Utility (<https://digit.in/xtudown>). When you fire it up, you should be looking at the System Information page. Let it idle for 5 minutes and check the Package temperature graph. This is now your baseline.

On the side panel, you will have a tab called Benchmarking. Navigate to that and run the benchmark. Keep an eye on the Max Core Frequency as well. Ideally, it should rise and then stay at a high level until the benchmark is over. There might be a few undulations, that's normal.

If you do notice that the Max Core Frequency drops sharply and stays low for a while, then your CPU just got throttled.

Now navigate to Advanced Tuning > Core. You'll find an option that says 'Core Voltage Offset'. You need to reduce it by 20-120 millivolts. The value is different for each processor. Start off by reducing it by 30mV (-0.030V) first. Apply the settings. Then go back to the benchmarking panel and run it again. If the throttling is still happening, go back and reduce Core Offset Voltage by 10mV. Rinse and repeat till the throttling no longer happens.

If you drop the value too much, then your processor will simply freeze and you'll have to reboot. That should tell you the lower limit for your core offset. Always stay above this limit.



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